



What to Expect When You Go to a Neurologist (For Kids)

VISITING A NEUROLOGIST IS A WAY TO LEARN HOW YOUR BRAIN, NERVES, AND MUSCLES ARE WORKING. EVEN THOUGH IT CAN SEEM A LITTLE INTIMIDATING AT FIRST, THE DOCTOR WILL GUIDE YOU THROUGH EACH STEP AND MAKE SURE YOU FEEL AS COMFORTABLE AS POSSIBLE. MOST OF THE VISIT INVOLVES TALKING, SIMPLE MOVEMENTS, AND FUN ACTIVITIES THAT HELP THE DOCTOR UNDERSTAND HOW YOUR BODY IS WORKING. THE BEST WAY YOU CAN APPROACH THESE APPOINTMENTS IS TO WORK WITH YOUR DOCTOR TO HELP THEM UNDERSTAND YOUR SITUATION CLEARLY SO THEY CAN HELP YOU TO THE BEST OF THEIR ABILITY.

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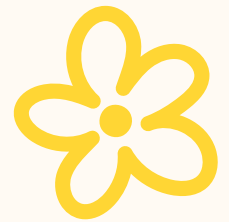
Talking With The Doctor



THE APPOINTMENT USUALLY STARTS
WITH THE NEUROLOGIST ASKING
QUESTIONS. THEY MIGHT ASK:



- WHY ARE YOU HERE TODAY?
- WHEN DID YOUR SYMPTOMS START?
- DOES ANYTHING MAKE THEM BETTER OR WORSE?
- HAVE YOU BEEN SICK OR INJURED RECENTLY?



THEY WILL ALSO ASK YOUR PARENT OR
GUARDIAN ABOUT YOUR HEALTH
HISTORY AND WHETHER ANYONE ELSE IN
YOUR FAMILY HAS SIMILAR PROBLEMS.
DON'T BE AFRAID TO ANSWER THE
DOCTOR'S QUESTIONS HONESTLY OR
SPEAK UP IF SOMETHING DOESN'T FEEL
RIGHT OR YOU HAVE QUESTIONS OF
YOUR OWN. THE MORE INFORMATION
YOU SHARE, THE EASIER IT IS FOR THE
NEUROLOGIST TO UNDERSTAND WHAT'S
GOING ON AND HELP YOU.



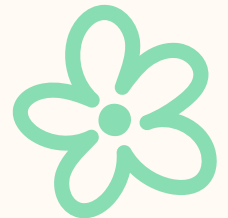
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The Neurological Exam

NEXT, THE DOCTOR WILL DO A NEUROLOGICAL EXAM. THIS IS A SERIES OF SIMPLE ACTIVITIES TO SEE HOW YOUR BRAIN AND NERVES ARE WORKING (WHICH ARE SOMETIMES KINDA FUN). YOU MIGHT BE ASKED TO:

- FOLLOW A LIGHT WITH YOUR EYES.
- SMILE, RAISE YOUR EYEBROWS, OR STICK OUT YOUR TONGUE.
- SQUEEZE THE DOCTOR'S HANDS.
- PUSH OR PULL WITH YOUR ARMS AND LEGS.
- WALK ACROSS THE ROOM, ON YOUR TIPTOES, OR HEEL-TO-TOE.
- TOUCH YOUR FINGER TO YOUR NOSE.
- FEEL A SOFT OBJECT TOUCHING YOUR SKIN.
- LET THE DOCTOR TAP YOUR KNEES WITH A SMALL RUBBER HAMMER TO CHECK YOUR REFLEXES.

MOST OF THESE ACTIVITIES FEEL LIKE PLAYING SIMPLE GAMES, AND THEY DO NOT HURT, SO DON'T BE SCARED

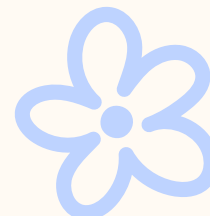


Special Tests

SOMETIMES THE NEUROLOGIST NEEDS MORE INFORMATION. THEY MIGHT ORDER TESTS SUCH AS:

- AN MRI, WHICH TAKES DETAILED PICTURES OF YOUR BRAIN OR SPINE.
- AN EEG, WHICH USES SMALL STICKERS PLACED ON YOUR HEAD TO MEASURE BRAIN ACTIVITY. IT DOES NOT HURT.
- AN EMG OR NERVE TEST TO SEE HOW WELL YOUR MUSCLES AND NERVES WORK.
- BLOOD TESTS, IF NEEDED, TO LOOK FOR OTHER CAUSES OF YOUR SYMPTOMS.

SOME WAYS TO REMAIN RELAXED DURING TESTS LIKE THESE ARE TO WATCH MOVIES, LISTEN TO YOUR FAVORITE SONGS, TAKE SLOW DEEP BREATHS, OR HOLD YOUR FAVORITE STUFFED ANIMAL IF POSSIBLE. IT SOMETIMES ALSO HELPS TO ASK ABOUT THE TESTS BEFOREHAND TO UNDERSTAND THE REASON BEHIND WHY YOU NEED THE TESTS DONE AND HOW IT WILL HELP IN YOUR DIAGNOSIS.



After The Visit

BEFORE YOU LEAVE, THE NEUROLOGIST WILL TALK WITH YOU AND YOUR PARENT OR GUARDIAN ABOUT WHAT THEY FOUND DURING THE VISIT. SOMETIMES THEY CAN EXPLAIN WHAT IS CAUSING YOUR SYMPTOMS RIGHT AWAY. OTHER TIMES, THEY MAY NEED TO WAIT FOR THE RESULTS OF TESTS, SUCH AS AN MRI, EEG, OR BLOOD WORK, BEFORE MAKING A DIAGNOSIS.

THE NEUROLOGIST WILL ALSO EXPLAIN THE NEXT STEPS IN YOUR CARE. THEY MAY PRESCRIBE MEDICINE, RECOMMEND PHYSICAL OR OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY, ORDER ADDITIONAL TESTS, OR SCHEDULE A FOLLOW-UP APPOINTMENT. THIS IS ALSO A GOOD TIME TO ASK QUESTIONS IF THERE IS ANYTHING YOU DON'T UNDERSTAND. THE GOAL IS TO MAKE SURE YOU AND YOUR FAMILY LEAVE WITH A CLEAR UNDERSTANDING OF WHAT HAPPENS NEXT AND HOW TO HELP YOU FEEL BETTER.

